



NIGHT WATCH

POLICEMEN STOP vehicles for a security check during a foggy night in Jammu ahead of Republic Day celebrations. Security is tightened to its highest levels every year for the nationwide event.

BK RAMESH



ESHWARAPPA (LEFT) AND YEDDYURAPPA

WITH ELECTIONS NEARING, BOTH THE JD(S) AND THE BJP HAVE HAD A CHANGE OF GUARD AT THE TOP.

BANGALORE | Warming Up

With Maratha strongman PGR Sindhia returning to Deve Gowda's Janata Dal-Secular (JD-S), a flood of prodigals is expected to follow suit. JD-S supremo H.D. Deve Gowda made Sindhia the working president of the state unit of the party, leaving the job of building political bridges to H.D. Kumaraswamy. With elections nearing, the BJP has replaced its state party president, Vokkaliga leader D.V. Sadananda Gowda, with K.S. Eshwarappa, state energy minister and Kuruba (shepherd) community leader. Eshwarappa, state BJP chief from 1993-96, belongs to Shimoga, Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa's home district. The BJP hopes Eshwarappa will attract Kuruba support. Sindhia, meanwhile, says his mission is to "strengthen the party, leverage its secular credentials, get minority support and bring back all the leaders who have left the party". Eshwarappa will also want to be the good shepherd the BJP needs to ward off challenges from within and without.

by Stephen David